

Q + A

KEEPING CALM, CARRYING ON

With her new web show Anamika *just having premiered on MX Player, actor-model* ***Sunny Leone*** *underscores the importance of staying the course*

Q. You were one of the first to take that OTT leap of faith with an autobiographical web series. Did you think streaming would take off in such a big way?

It is the direction the industry should have taken a long time ago. Earlier, if you were on TV or on OTT, it was looked down upon. Because of Covid, things have changed. Now, the idea is to just keep working and keep finding different projects that need not be confined to the big screen.

Q. You are playing the titular part in *Anamika*. Do you feel actresses are getting meatier roles on OTT?

I think it is gender agnostic. We have been seeing different shows that make us go, 'Who is this person? They are amazing.' People across the board are getting to showcase their talent. They couldn't do this earlier because people told them that they had to be in cinemas to be popular.

Q. How difficult has it been to break out of the image you came with?

It has been a rollercoaster. I thought if I just stick around, they will be like, 'She is still here, let's hire her and put her in a film, a song, a show or an ad film.' My mantra was to keep working, get more experience, build more interest. Sometimes my character needs the sexuality to perform better. I am okay with it. Why would I cut myself off from the experience of a show or film?

Q. Has motherhood affected the choices you make now?

Not much. I am not going to ask my four-year-old, 'Hey, should I do this film?' I don't think it's my child's choice to dictate how I live my life. I would like to teach my kids how to make their own decisions and be independent. I may not like that choice but as long as they aren't physically or emotionally hurting someone, they should be able to do what they want in life, too.

–with Suhani Singh